Vittoria Iannotta

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Research Interests

I am a researcher working in macro-finance and banking. I study how banks and firms interact in the market for credit: what determines loan pricing, how credit is allocated across firms, and how monetary policy affects equilibrium outcomes.

Education

PhD candidate in Economics at **HEC Paris** 2023 - present

Advisor: Prof. Gaetano Gaballo

- Summer 2025, Summer Graduate Program in honor of Ivan Jaccard,
  Financial Research Division, **European Central Bank**
  References: Simone Manganelli, David Marqués-Ibáñez
- Fall 2024, Visiting Scholar, **University of Pennsylvania**, Department of Economics.
  Sponsor: Prof. Guillermo Ordonez
- Spring 2023, Visiting Scholar, **Banque de France**, Financial Economics Research Division.
  Worked with *fintech-related data* and explored potential empirical applications.

M.S. in Management Sciences - **HEC Paris** 2021 - 2023

M.S. in Economic and Social Sciences - **Bocconi University**
Thesis Supervisor: Prof. Francesco Giavazzi 2017 - 2020

B.S. in Economic and Social Sciences - **Bocconi University** 2014 - 2017

References

Prof. Gaetano Gaballo (Supervisor)
Professor of Economics, HEC Paris
gaballo@hec.fr

Prof. Refet S. Gürkaynak
Professor of Economics, Bilkent University
refet@bilkent.edu.tr

Prof. Johan Hombert
Professor of Finance, HEC Paris
hombert@hec.fr

Prof. Benjamin Lester
Vice President and Economist,
Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia
Benjamin.Lester@phil.frb.org

Job Market Paper

Default Risk Surprises in Banks' Loan Pricing.
In the loan market, similar firms pay different rates, even when they borrow the same loan type from the same bank. Do these differentials reflect market imperfections, or information banks have and the econometrician does not? Using two million French loans from 2006–2024 matched to firms' credit ratings assigned by Banque de France, I show that rate differentials predict subsequent changes in firms' credit risk. On average, firms whose

default probability increases by 1 p.p. one year after loan issuance were charged an otherwise unexplained 0.04 p.p. rate premium at issuance. The premium doubles for younger and smaller firms, strengthens in crises and at longer maturities. The positive relationship is consistent with banks having information that the econometrician does not observe; yet, it can also emerge in a market with search frictions, when banks' pricing strategies induce partial separation. I bring these forces together in a search model of loan pricing with asymmetric information in which banks see an imperfect public signal of firms' risk types. Calibrating the model within each rating class, I find that banks are informed and separate borrowers in the safest classes but are uninformed and pool them in the riskiest, and search frictions explain most of the dispersion.

Other work in Progress

When Lenders Disagree.
I model banks' endogenous information acquisition on firms' types under asymmetric information and imperfect competition. Each bank independently chooses its screening precision and draws a binary signal on the borrower type that is independent of its rival's one, conditional on the borrower type. Disagreement implies that a bank that drew a good signal on a firm may be bidding against a rival that drew a bad one. Equilibrium rates are dispersed, and, when the signal is informative, banks post lower rates when observing a good signal. The value of information depends on whether the rate ranges associated with the two signals share a rate: in this case, an uninformed bank can earn the informed bank's profits by posting a shared rate. Therefore, with a positive and strictly increasing cost of information, only two market configurations survive: banks remain uninformed, or become informed when the two signals' rate ranges are disjoint.

Lender Heterogeneity in the Pricing of Bundled Credit.
I document new empirical evidence on banks' pricing of bundles, namely multiple products issued to the same firm in the same month. I compare the price of a product in a bundle against the price of the same product issued individually. Across 99 French lenders, the average gap is -0.05 percentage points, close to zero, but it hides a spread of 1.69 percentage points: nineteen lenders charge a premium, fifteen give a discount, and the rest show no significant gap. Which products a lender sells accounts for 4.9 percent of the variance across lenders, and the rating, size, age and leverage of its borrowers for 0.6 percent. The price gap does not evolve significantly over the bank–firm relationship. Therefore, most of the bundling strategy remains unexplained, and may rather be attributed to lender-specific strategies. This result highlights the strategic choices made by individual banks, and it opens several questions on borrowers' myopia and price discrimination.

Presentations

The **Wharton School, Finance** (Internal presentation), Fall 2024. **Paris Macro Workshop**, May 2025. **European Central Bank** (Internal Seminar), May 2025. Economics Letters Summer School in Macro-Finance at **Bocconi SDA**, July 2025. **ICBFS Conference**, Piacenza, Sep 2025. 4th PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop, Naples School of Economics (NSE) of the **University of Naples Federico II**, Sep 2025. 9th Dauphine Finance PhD Workshop, **Université Paris Dauphine - PSL**, June 2026. **European Summer Symposium in Financial Markets** (Evening Sessions), Jul 2026. **Fourth Women in Central Banking Workshop**, Banco de Mexico, (scheduled Nov 6th).

Work Experience

Research Analyst, European Central Bank Apr 2020 - Jun 2021

Title: Traineeship (1 year) + Research Analyst (3 months). *Area:* Monetary Analysis.
Main Activities: Data collection (Orbis, ECB series), macroeconometric analysis of time series data (including monetary aggregates, bank lending volumes and interest rates), Microeconometric analysis of firm panel data (balance sheets, firm-bond links). *References:* Fédéric Holm-Hadulla

Teaching Experience

Lecturer, Introduction to Macroeconomics. 2022, 2023

Program: MSc in Economics and Finance, HEC Paris. *Latest teaching evaluations*: 4.32/5 (2023/24).

Teaching assistant for Prof. Michau, Advanced Macroeconomics. 2023, 2024, 2025

Program: MSc in Economics, Ecole Polytechnique. *Latest teaching evaluations*: 4.22/5 (2024/25)

Teaching assistant for Prof Ai-Ting Goh, Macroeconomics. 2024, 2025

Program: MBA simulation games, HEC Paris.

Instructor for ESSEC IRENE France, Game Theory for Negotiation 2026

Program: One-day Professional Training, delivered at the Council of the European Union.

Skills

Datasets experience:

Credit registries: French Credit Registries, P2P lenders registry (ACPR, Banque de France)
Firm-level data: National balance sheet data (FIBEN, Bank of France), Orbis,Amadeus (BvD)
Financial analysis: Eikon, Datastream
Macroeconomic analysis: ECB series, BSI, MIR

Statistical Packages and Programming:

R, Stata, Matlab	(Advanced) data management, statistical and econometric analysis, visualisation
Python	(Advanced) structural estimation, model simulations, visualization, webscraping.
SQL	(Intermediate) data management
SPSS, Eviews	(Basic) data management, statistical and econometric analysis
Microsoft Office	PowerPoint, Word, Excel

Organized Conferences

Co-founder and co-organizer, HEC Economics PhD Conference. 2023–2026

Student-led workshop supported by the Faculty of Economics and Decision Sciences Department at HEC Paris. Its purpose is to provide an opportunity for Economics PhD students to share their work, obtain valuable feedback, network with international peers and improve their presentation skills.

Languages

Italian (Native), English (Proficient), French (Advanced).